

FLEX™ Programmer's Manual

Technical Systems Consultants, Inc.

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CONTENTS

I. Introduction	1
II. Disk Operating System	3
DOS Memory Map	3
User Callable Routines	8
User Written Commands	16
Disk Resident Commands	17
Comments about Commands	18
Examples of DOS Calls	19
III. File Management System	21
File Control Blocks	22
FMS Entry Points	26
FMS Global Variables	27
Random Files	37
Error Numbers	38
IV. Disk Drivers	41
V. Disk Structures	43
Diskette Initialization	43
Directory Sectors	44
Data Sectors	44
Binary Files	45
Text Files	46
VI. Writing Utility Commands	47
Example Program	49
VII. The DOS LINK Utility	49
VIII. Printer Routines	53
The P Utility	54
IX. General Information	57
Interrupts in Flex	57
System Memory Map	57

Preface

The purpose of the Advanced Programmer's Manual is to provide the assembler language programmer with the information required to make effective use of the available system routines and functions. This manual applies to the 6809 version of FLEX. The programmer should keep this manual close at hand while learning the system. It is organized to make it convenient as a quick reference guide as well as a thorough reference manual. The manual is not written for the novice programmer and assumes the user to have a thorough understanding of assembler language programming techniques.

Introduction

The FLEX Operating System consists of three main parts: the Disk Operating System (DOS) which processes commands, the File Management System (FMS) which manages files on a diskette, and the Utility Command Set, which are the user-callable commands. The Utility Command Set is described in the FLEX User's Guide. Details of the Disk Operating System and File Management System portions of FLEX are described in this manual, which is intended for the programmer who wishes to write his own commands or process disk files from his own program.

When debugging programs which use disk files and the File Management System, the user should take the following precautions:

1. Write-protect the system diskette by exposing or covering the write-protect cutout on the diskette. See the FLEX User's Guide for further details on this operation. This will prevent destruction of the system disk in case the program starts running wild.
2. Use an empty scratch diskette as the working diskette to which your program will write any data files. If something goes wrong and the diskette is destroyed, no valuable data will have been lost.
3. Test your program repeatedly, especially with "special cases" of data input which may not be what the program is expecting. Well-written programs abort gracefully when detecting errors, not dramatically.

A careful programmer, using the information in this manual, should be able to make the fullest use of his floppy disk system.

DISCLAIMER

This product is intended for use only as described in this document and the FLEX User's Guide. Technical Systems Consultants will not be responsible for the proper functioning of features or parameters. The user is urged to abide by the warnings and cautions issued in this document lest valuable data or diskettes be destroyed.

PATCHING "FLEX"

It is not possible to patch FLEX. Technical Systems Consultants cannot be responsible for any destructive side-effects which may result from attempts to patch FLEX.

THE DISK OPERATING SYSTEM

The Disk Operating System (DOS) forms the communication link between the user (via a computer terminal) and the File Management System. All commands are accepted through DOS. Functions such as file specification parsing, command argument parsing, terminal I/O, and error reporting are all handled by DOS. The following sections describe the DOS global variable storage locations (Memory Map), the DOS user callable subroutines, and give examples of some possible uses.

DOS MEMORY MAP

The following is a description of those memory locations within the DOS portion of FLEX which contain information of interest to the programmer. The user is cautioned against utilizing for his own purposes any locations documented as being either "reserved" or "system scratch", as this action may cause destruction of data.

\$C080-\$C0FF - Line Buffer

The line buffer is a 128 byte area into which characters typed at the keyboard are placed by the routine INBUF. All characters entered from the keyboard are placed in this buffer with the exception of control characters. Characters which have been deleted by entering the backspace character do not appear in the buffer, nor does the backspace character itself appear. The carriage return signaling the end of the keyboard input is, however, put in the buffer. This buffer is also used to hold the STARTUP file during a coldstart (boot) operation.

\$CC00 - TTYSET Backspace Character

This is the character which the routine INBUF will interpret as the Backspace character. It is user definable through the TTYSET DOS Utility. Default = \$08, a Control-H (ASCII BS).

\$CC01 - TTYSET Delete Character

This is the character which the routine INBUF will interpret as the line cancel or Delete character. It is user definable through the TTYSET DOS Utility. Default = \$18, a control-X (ASCII CAN).

\$CC02 - TTYSET End of Line Character

This is the character DOS recognizes as the multiple command per line separator. It is user definable through the TTYSET Utility. Default = \$3A, a colon (:).

\$CC03 - TTYSET Depth Count

This byte determines how many lines DOS will print on a page before Pausing or issuing Ejects. It may be set by the user with the TTYSET command. Default = 0.

\$CC04 - TTYSET Width Count

This byte tells DOS how many characters to output on each line. If zero there is no limit to the number output. This count may be set by the user using TTYSET. Default = 0.

FLEX Advanced Programmer's Guide

\$CC05 - TTYSET Null Count

This byte informs DOS of the number of null or pad characters to be output after each carriage return, line feed pair. This count may be set using TTYSET. Default = 4.

\$CC06 - TTYSET Tab Character

This byte defines a tab character which may be used by other programs, such as the Editor. DOS itself does not make use of the Tab character. Default = 0, no tab character defined.

\$CC07 - TTYSET Backspace Echo Character

This is the character the routine INBUF will echo upon the receipt of a backspace character. If the backspace echo character is set to a \$08, and the backspace character is also a \$08, FLEX will output a space (\$20) prior to the outputting of the backspace echo character. Default = 0.

\$CC08 - TTYSET Eject Count

The Eject Count instructs DOS as to the number of blank lines to be output after each page. (A page is a set of lines equal in number to the Depth Count). If this byte is zero, no Eject lines are output. Default = 0.

\$CC09 - TTYSET Pause Control

The Pause byte instructs DOS what action to take after each page is output. A zero value indicates that the pause feature is enabled; a non-zero value, pause is disabled. Default = \$FF, pause disabled.

\$CC0A - TTYSET Escape Character

The Escape character causes DOS to pause after an output line. Default = \$1B, ASCII ESC.

\$CC0B - System Drive Number

This is the number of the disk drive from which commands are loaded. If this byte is \$FF, both drives 0 and 1 will be searched. Default = drive #0.

\$CC0C - Working Drive Number

This is the number of the default disk drive referenced for non-command files. If this byte is \$FF, both drives 0 and 1 will be searched. Default = drive #0.

\$CC0D - System Scratch

\$CC0E-\$CC10 - System Date Registers

These three bytes are used to store the system date. It is stored in binary form with the month in the first byte, followed by the day, then the year. The year byte contains only the tens and ones digits.

\$CC11 - Last Terminator

This location contains the most recent non-alphanumeric character encountered in processing the line buffer. See commentary on the routines NXTCH and CLASS in the section "User-Callable System Routines".

\$CC12-\$CC13 - User Command Table Address

The programmer may store into these locations the address of a command table of his own construction. See the section called "User-Written Commands" for details. Default = 0000, no user command table is defined.

\$CC14-\$CC15 - Line Buffer Pointer

These locations contain the address of the next character in the Line Buffer to be processed. See documentation of the routines INBUFF, NXTCH, GETFIL, GETCHR, and DOCMND in the section "User-Callable System Routines" for instances of its use.

\$CC16-\$CC17 - Escape Return Register

These locations contain the address to which to jump if a RETURN is typed while output has been stopped by an Escape Character. See the FLEX User's Guide, TTYSET, for information on Escape processing. See also the documentation for the routine PCRLF in the section called "User-Callable System Routines".

\$CC18 - Current Character

This location contains the most recent character taken from the Line Buffer by the NXTCH routine. See documentation of the NXTCH routine for additional details.

\$CC19 - Previous Character

This location contains the previous character taken from the Line Buffer by the NXTCH routine. See documentation of the NXTCH routine for additional details.

\$CC1A - Current Line Number

This location contains a count of the number of lines currently on the page. This value is compared to the Line Count value to determine if a full page has been printed.

\$CC1B-\$CC1C - Loader Address Offset

These locations contain the 16-bit bias to be added to the load address of a routine being loaded from the disk. See documentation of the System Routine LOAD for details. These locations are also used as scratch by some system routines.

\$CC1D - Transfer Flag

After a program has been loaded from the disk (see LOAD documentation), this location is non-zero if a transfer address was found during the loading process. This location is also used as scratch by some system routines.

\$CC1E-\$CC1F - Transfer Address

If the Transfer Flag was set non-zero by a load from the disk (See LOAD documentation), these locations contain the last transfer address encountered. If the Transfer Flag was set zero by the disk load, the content of these locations is indeterminate.

\$CC20 - Error Type

This location contains the error number returned by several of the Management System functions. See the "Error Numbers" section of this document for an interpretation of the error numbers.

\$CC21 - Special I/O Flag

If this byte is non-zero, the PUTCHR routine will ignore the TTYSET Width feature and also ignore the Escape Character. The routine RSTRIO clears this byte. Default = 0.

\$CC22 - Output Switch

If zero, output performed by the PUTCHR routine is through the routine OUTCH. If non-zero, the routine OUTCH2 is used. See documentation of these routines for details.

\$CC23 - Input Switch

If zero, input performed by GETCHR is through the routine INCH. If it is non-zero, the routine INCH2 is used. See documentation of these routines for details.

\$CC24-\$CC25 - File Output Address

These bytes contain the address of the File Control Block being used for file output. If the bytes are zero, no file output is performed. See PUTCHR description for details. These locations are set to zero by RSTRIO.

\$CC26-\$CC27 - File Input Address

These bytes contain the address of the File Control Block being used for file input. If the bytes are zero, no file input is performed. The routine RSTRIO clears these bytes. See GETCHR for details.

\$CC28 - Command Flag

This location is non-zero if DOS was called from a user program via the DOCMND entry point. See documentation of DOCMND for details.

\$CC29 - Current Output Column

This location contains a count of the number of characters currently in the line being output to the terminal. This is compared to the TTYSET Width Count to determine when to start a new line. The output of a control character resets this count to zero.

\$CC2A - System Scratch

\$CC2B-\$CC2C - Memory End

These two bytes contain the end of user memory. This location is set during system boot and may be read by programs requiring this information.

\$CC2D-\$CC2E - Error Name Vector

If these bytes are zero, the routine RPTERR will use the file ERRORS.SYS as the error file. If they are non-zero, they are assumed to be the address of an ASCII string of characters (in directory format) of the name of the file to be used as the error file. See the description of RPTERR for more details.

\$CC2F - File Input Echo Flag

If this byte is non-zero (default) and input is being done through a file, the character input will be echoed to the output channel. If this byte is zero, the character retrieved will not be echoed.

\$CC30-\$CC4D - System Scratch**\$CC4E-\$CCBF - System Constants****\$CCC0-\$CCD7 - Printer Initialize**

This area is reserved for the overlay of the system printer initialization subroutine.

\$CCD8-\$CCE3 - Printer Ready Check

This area is reserved for the overlay of the system "check for printer ready" subroutine.

\$CCE4-\$CCF7 - Printer Output

This area is reserved for the overlay of the system printer output character routine. See Printer Routine descriptions for details.

\$CCF8-\$CCFF - System Scratch

USER-CALLABLE SYSTEM ROUTINES

Unless specifically documented otherwise, the content of all registers should be presumed destroyed by calls to these routines. All routines, unless otherwise indicated, should be called with a JSR instruction. In the 6809 version of FLEX the Y and U registers are preserved across all the following routines. The A,B and X registers should be considered changed except where noted otherwise. Often a value or status is returned in one of these registers.

\$CD00 (COLDS) Coldstart Entry Point

The BOOT program loaded from the disk jumps to this address to initialize the FLEX system. Both the Disk Operating System (DOS) portion and the File Management System portion (FMS) of FLEX are initialized. After initialization, the FLEX title line is printed and the STARTUP file, if one exists, is loaded and executed. This entry point is only for use by the BOOT program, not by user programs. Indiscriminate use of the Coldstart Entry Point by user programs could result in the destruction of the diskette. Documentation of this routine is included here only for completeness.

\$CD03 (WARMS) Warmstart Entry Point

This is the main re-entry point into DOS from user programs. A JMP instruction should be used to enter the Warmstart Entry Point. At this point, the main loop of DOS is entered. The main loop of DOS checks the Last Terminator location for a TTYSET end-of-line character. If one is found, it is assumed that there is another command on the line, and DOS attempts to process it. If no end-of-line is in the Last Terminator location DOS assumes that the current command line is finished, and looks for a new line to be input from the keyboard. If, however, DOS was called from a user program through the DOCMND entry point, control will be returned to the user program when the end of a command line is reached.

\$CD06 (RENTER) DOS Main Loop Re-entry Point

This is a direct entry point into the DOS main loop. None of the Warmstart initialization is performed. This entry point must be entered by a JMP instruction. Normally, this entry point is used internally by DOS and user-written programs should not have need to use it. For an example of use, see "Printer Driver" section for details.

\$CD09 (INCH) Input Character

\$CD0C (INCH2) Input Character

Each of these routines inputs one character from the keyboard, returning it to the calling program in the A-register. The address portion of these entries points to a routine in the Custom I/O package. They may be altered by changing that package. The GETCHR routine normally uses INCH but may be instructed to use INCH2 by setting the "Input Switch" non-zero (see Memory Map). The user's program may change the jump vector at the INCH address to refer to some other input routine such as a routine to get a character from paper tape. The INCH2 address should never be altered. The Warmstart Entry Point resets the INCH jump vector to the same routine as INCH2 and sets the Input Switch to zero. RSTRIO also resets these bytes. User programs should use the GETCHR routine, documented below, rather than calling INCH, because INCH does not check the TTYSET parameters.

\$CD0F (OUTCH) Output Character

\$CD12 (OUTCH2) Output Character

On entry to each of these routines, the A-register should contain the character being output. Both of these routines output the character in the A-register to an output device. The OUTCH routine usually does the same as OUTCH2; however, OUTCH may be changed by programs to refer to some other output routine. For example, OUTCH may be changed to drive a line printer. OUTCH2 is never changed, and always points to the output routine in the Custom I/O package. This address may not be patched to refer to some other output routine. The routine PUTCHR, documented below, calls one of these two routines, depending on the content of the location "Output Switch" (see Memory Map). The Warmstart Entry Point resets the OUTCH jump vector to the same routine as OUTCH2, and sets the Output Switch to zero. RSTRIO also resets these locations. User routines should use PUTCHR rather than calling OUTCH or OUTCH2 directly since these latter two do not check the TTYSET parameters.

\$CD15 (GETCHR) Get Character

This routine gets a single character from the keyboard. The character is returned to the calling program in the A-register. The Current Line Number location is cleared by a call to GETCHR. Because this routine honors the TTYSET parameters, its use is preferred to that of INCH. If the location "Input Switch" is non-zero, the routine INCH2 will be used for input. If zero, the byte at "File Input Address" is checked. If it is non-zero, the address at this location is used as a File Control Block of a previously opened input file and a character is retrieved from the file. If zero, a character is retrieved via the INCH routine. The X and B registers are preserved.

\$CD18 (PUTCHR) Put Character

This routine outputs a character to a device, honoring all of the TTYSET parameters. On entry, the character should be in the A-register. If the "Special I/O Flag" (see Memory Map) is zero, the column count is checked, and a new line is started if the current line is full. If an ACIA is being used to control the monitor terminal, it is checked for a TTYSET Escape Character having been typed. If so, output will pause at the end of the current line. If the location "Output Switch" is non-zero, the routine OUTCH2 is used to send the character. If zero, the location File Output Address is checked. If it is non-zero the contents of this location is used as a address of a File Control Block of a previously opened for write file, and the character is written to the file. If zero, the routine OUTCH is called to process the character. Normally, OUTCH sends the character to the terminal. The user program may, however, change the address portion of the OUTCH entry point to go to another character output routine. The X and B registers are preserved.

\$CD1B (INBUFF) Input into Line Buffer

This routine inputs a line from the keyboard into the Line Buffer. The TTYSET Backspace and Delete characters are checked and processed if encountered. All other control characters except RETURN and LINE FEED, are ignored. The RETURN is placed in the buffer at the end of the line. A LINE FEED is entered into the buffer as a space character but is echoed back to the terminal as a Carriage Return and Line Feed pair for continuation of the text on a new line. At most, 128 characters may be entered on the line, including the final RETURN. If more are entered, only the first 127 are kept, the RETURN being the 128th. On exit, the Line Buffer Pointer is pointing to the first character in the Line Buffer. Caution: The command line entered from the keyboard is kept in the Line Buffer. Calling INBUF from a user program will destroy the command line, including all unprocessed commands on the same line. Using INBUF and the Line Buffer for other than DOS commands may result in unpredictable side-effects.

\$CD1E (PSTRNG) Print String

This routine is similar to the PDATA routine in SWTBUG and DISKBUG. On entry, the X-register should contain the address of the first character of the string to be printed. The string must end with an ASCII EOT character (\$04). This routine honors all of the TTYSET conventions when printing the string. A carriage return and line feed are output before the string. The B register is preserved.

\$CD21 (CLASS) Classify Character

This routine is used for testing if a character is alphanumeric (i.e. a letter or a number). On entry, the character should be in the A-register. If the character is alphanumeric, the routine returns with the carry flag cleared. If the character is not alphanumeric, the carry flag is set and the character is stored in the Last Terminator location. All registers are preserved by this routine.

\$CD24 (PCRLF) Print Carriage Return and Line Feed

In addition to printing a carriage return and line feed, this routine checks and honors several TTYSET conditions. On entry, this routine checks for a TTYSET Escape Character having been entered while the previous line was being printed. If so, the routine waits for another TTYSET Escape Character or a RETURN to be typed. If a RETURN was entered, the routine clears the Last Terminator location so as to ignore any commands remaining in the command line, and then jumps to the address contained in the Escape Return Register locations. Unless changed by the user's program, this address is that of the Warmstart Entry Point. If, instead of a RETURN, another TTYSET Escape Character was typed, or it wasn't necessary to wait for one, the Current Line Number is checked. If the last line of the page has been printed and the TTYSET Pause feature is enabled, the routine waits for a RETURN or a TTYSET Escape Character, as above. Note that all pausing is done before the carriage return and line feed are printed. The carriage return and line feed are now printed, followed by the number of nulls specified by the TTYSET Null Count. If the end of the page was encountered on entry to this routine, an "eject" is performed by issuing additional carriage return, line feeds, and nulls until the total number of blank lines is that specified in the TTYSET Eject Count. The X register is preserved.

\$CD27 (NXTCH) Get Next Buffer Character

The character in location Current Character is placed in location Previous Character. The character to which the Line Buffer Pointer points is taken from the Line Buffer and saved in the Current Character location. Multiple spaces are skipped so that a string of spaces looks no different than a single space. The Line Buffer Pointer is advanced to point to the next character unless the character just fetched was a RETURN or TTYSET End-of-Line character. Thus, once an end-of-line character or RETURN is encountered, additional calls to NXTCH will continue to return the same end-of-line character or RETURN. NXTCH cannot be used to cross into the next command in the buffer. NXTCH exits through the routine CLASS, automatically classifying the character. On exit, the character is in the A-register, the carry is clear if the character is alphanumeric, and the B-register and X-register are preserved.

\$CD2A (RSTRIO) Restore I/O Vectors

This routine forces the OUTCH jump vector to point to the same routine as does the OUTCH2 vector. The Output Switch location and the Input Switch location are set to zero. The INCH jump vector is reset to point to the same address as the INCH2 vector. Both the File Input Address and the File Output Address are set to zero. The A-register and B-register are preserved by this routine.

\$CD2D (GETFIL) Get File Specification

On entry to this routine, the X-register must contain the address of a File Control Block (FCB), and the Line Buffer Pointer must be pointing to the first character of a file specification in the Line Buffer. This routine will parse the file specification, storing the various components in the FCB to which the X-register points. If a drive number was not specified in the file specification, the working drive number will be used. On exit, the carry bit will be clear if no error was detected in processing the file specification. The carry bit will be set if there was a format error in the file specification. If no extension was specified in the file specification, none is stored. The calling program should set the default extension desired after GETFIL has been called by using the SETEXT routine. The Line Buffer Pointer is left pointing to the character immediately beyond the separator, unless the Separator is a carriage return or End of Line character. If an error was detected, Error number 21 is stored in the error status byte of the FCB. The X register is preserved with a call to this routine.

\$CD30 (LOAD) File Loader

On entry, the system File Control Block (at \$C840) must contain the name of a file which has been opened for binary reading. This routine is used to load binary files only, not text files. The file is read from the disk and stored in memory, normally at the load addresses specified in the binary file itself. It is possible to load a binary file into a different memory area by using the Loader Address Offset locations. The 16-bit value in the Loader Address Offset locations is added to the addresses read from the binary file. Any carry generated out of the most significant bit of the address is lost. The transfer address, if any is encountered, is not modified by the Loader Address Offset. Note that the setting of a value in the Loader Address Offset does not modify any part of the content of the binary file. It does not act as a program relocater in that it does not change any addresses in the program itself, merely the location of the program in memory. If the file is to be loaded without an offset, be certain to clear the Loader Address Offset locations before calling this routine. On exit, the Transfer Address Flag is zero if no transfer address was found. This flag is non-zero if a transfer address record was encountered in the binary file, and the Transfer Address locations contain the last transfer address encountered. The disk file is closed on exit. If a disk error is encountered,

an error message is issued and control is returned to DOS at the Warmstart Entry Point.

\$CD33 (SETEXT) Set Extension

On entry, the X-register should contain the address of the FCB into which the default extension is to be stored if there is not an extension already in the FCB. The A-register, on entry, should contain a numeric code indicating what the default extension is to be. The numeric codes are described below. If there is already an extension in the FCB (possibly stored there by a call to GETFIL), this routine returns to the calling program immediately. If there is no extension in the FCB, the extension indicated by the numeric code in the A-register is placed in the FCB File Extension area. The legal codes are:

- 0 - BIN
- 1 - TXT
- 2 - CMD
- 3 - BAS
- 4 - SYS
- 5 - BAK
- 6 - SCR
- 7 - DAT
- 8 - BAC
- 9 - DIR
- 10- PRT
- 11- OUT

Any values other than those above are ignored, the routine returning without storing any extension. The X register is preserved in this routine.

\$CD36 (ADDBX) Add B-register to X-register

The content of the B-register is added to the content of the X-register. This routine is here for compatibility with 6800 FLEX.

\$CD39 (OUTDEC) Output Decimal Number

On entry, the X-register contains the address of the most significant byte of a 16-bit (2 byte), unsigned, binary number. The B-register, on entry, should contain a space suppression flag. The number will be printed as a decimal number with leading zeroes suppressed. If the B-register was non-zero on entry, spaces will be substituted for the leading zeroes. If the B-register is zero on entry, printing of the number will start with the first non-zero digit.

\$CD3C (OUTHEX) Output Hexadecimal Number

On entry, the X-register contains the address of a single binary byte. The byte to which the X-register points is printed as 2 hexadecimal digits. The B and X registers are preserved.

\$CD3F (RPTERR) Report Error

On entry to this routine, the X-register contains the address of a File Control Block in which the Error Status Byte is non-zero. The error code in the FCB is stored by this routine in the Error Type location. A call to the routine RSTRIO is made and location Error Vector is checked. If this location is zero, the file ERRORS.SYS is opened for random read. If this location is non-zero, it is assumed to be an address pointing to an ASCII string (containing any necessary null pad characters) of a legal File name plus extension (string should be 11 characters long). This user provided file is then opened for random read. The error number is used in a calculation to determine the record number and offset of the appropriate error string message in the file. Each error message string is 63 characters in length, thus allowing 4 messages per sector. If the string is found, it is printed on the terminal. If the string is not found (due to too large of error number being encountered) or if the error file itself was not located on the disk, the error number is reported to the monitor terminal as part of the message:

DISK ERROR #nnn

Where "nnn" is the error number being reported. A description of the error numbers is given elsewhere in this document.

\$CD42 (GETHEX) Get Hexadecimal Number

This routine gets a hexadecimal number from the Line Buffer. On entry, the Line Buffer Pointer must point to the first character of the number in the Line Buffer. On exit, the carry bit is cleared if a valid number was found, the B-register is set non-zero, and the X-register contains the value of the number. The Line Buffer Pointer is left pointing to the character immediately following the separator character, unless that character is a carriage return or End of Line. If the first character examined in the Line Buffer is a separator character (such as a comma), the carry bit is still cleared, but the B-register is set to zero indicating that no actual number was found. In this case, the value returned in the X-register is zero. If a non-hexadecimal character is found while processing the number, characters in the Line Buffer are skipped until a separator character is found, then the routine returns to the caller with the carry bit set. The number in the Line Buffer may be of any length, but the value is truncated to between 0 and \$FFFF, inclusive.

\$CD45 (OUTADR) Output Hexadecimal Address

On entry, the X register contains the address of the 1st significant byte of a 2 byte hex value. The bytes to which the X register points are printed as 4 hexadecimal digits.

\$CD48 (INDEC) Input Decimal Number

This routine gets an unsigned decimal number from the Line Buffer. On entry, the Line Buffer Pointer must point to the first character of the number in the Line Buffer. On exit, the carry bit is cleared if a valid number was found, the B-register is set non-zero, and the X-register contains the binary value of the number. The Line Buffer Pointer is left pointing as described in the routine GETHEX. If the first character examined in the buffer is a separator character (such as a comma), the carry bit is still cleared, but the B-register is set to zero indicating that no actual number was found. In this case, the number returned in X is zero. The number in the Line Buffer may be of any length but the result is truncated to 16 bit precision.

\$CD4B (DOCMND) Call DOS as a Subroutine

This entry point allows a user-written program to pass a command string to DOS for processing, and have DOS return control to the user program on completion of the commands. The command string must be placed in the Line Buffer by the user program, and the Line Buffer Pointer must be pointing to the first character of the command string. Note that this will destroy any as yet unprocessed parameters and commands in the Line Buffer. The command string must terminate with a RETURN character (\$D hex). After the commands have been processed, DOS will return control to the user's program with the B-register containing any error code received from the File Management System. The B-register will be zero if no errors were detected. Caution: do not use this feature to load programs which may destroy the user program in memory. An example of a use of this feature of DOS is that of a program wanting to save a portion of memory as a binary file on the disk. The program could build a SAVE command in the Line Buffer with the desired file name and parameters, and call the DOCMND entry point. On return, the memory will have been saved on the disk.

\$CD4E (STAT) Check Terminal Input Status

This routine may be called to check the status of the terminal input device (to see if a character has been typed on the keyboard). If a character has been hit, the Z condition code will be cleared on return (a not-equal condition). If no character has been hit, the Z condition code will be set (an equal condition). No registers, other than the CC-register, are altered.

USER-WRITTEN COMMANDS

The programmer may write his own commands for DOS. These commands may be either disk-resident as disk files with a CMD extension, or they may be memory-resident in either RAM or ROM.

MEMORY-RESIDENT COMMANDS:

A memory-resident command is a program, already in memory, to which DOS will transfer when the proper command is entered from the keyboard. The command which invokes the program, and the entry-point of the program, are stored in a User Command Table created by the programmer in memory. Each entry in the User Command Table has the following format:

```
FCC 'command' (Name that will invoke the program)
FCB 0
FDB entry address (This is the entry address of the program)
```

The entire table is ended by a zero byte. For example, the following table contains the commands DEBUG (entry at \$3000) and PUNT (entry at \$3200):

```
FCC 'DEBUG'      Command Name
FCB 0
FDB $3000        Entry address for DEBUG
FCC 'PUNT'       Command name
FCB 0
FDB $3200        Entry address for PUNT
FCB 0            End of command table
```

The address of the User Command Table is made known to DOS by storing it in the User Command Table Address locations (See Memory Map).

The User Command Table is searched before the disk directory, but after DOS's own command table is searched. The DOS command table contains only the GET and MON commands. Therefore, the user may not define his own GET and MON commands.

Since the User Command Table is searched before the disk directory, the programmer may have commands with the same name as those on the disk. However, in this case, the commands on the disk will never be executed while the User Command Table is known to DOS. The User Command Table may be deactivated by clearing the User Command Table Address locations.

DISK-RESIDENT COMMANDS

A disk-resident command is an assembled program, with a transfer address, which has been saved on the disk with a CMD extension. The ASMB section of the FLEX User's Guide describes the way to assign a transfer address to a program being assembled.

Disk commands, when loaded into memory, may reside anywhere in the User RAM Area; the address is determined at assembly time by using an ORG statement. Most commands may be assembled to run in the Utility Command Space (see Memory Map). Most of the commands supplied with FLEX run in the Utility Command Space. For this reason, the SAVE command cannot be used to save information which is in the Utility Command Space or System FCB space as this information would be destroyed when the SAVE command is loaded. The SAVE.LOW command is to be used in this case. The SAVE.LOW command loads into memory at location \$100 and allows the saving of programs in the \$C100 region.

The System FCB area is used to load all commands from the disk. Commands written to run in the Utility Command Space must not overflow into the System FCB area. Once loaded, the command itself may use the System FCB area for scratch or as an FCB for its own disk I/O. See the example in the FMS section.

GENERAL COMMENTS ABOUT COMMANDS

User-written commands are entered by a JMP instruction. On completion, they should return control to DOS by jumping (JMP instruction) to the Warmstart Entry Point (see Memory Map).

Processing Arguments.

User-written commands are required to process any arguments entered from the keyboard. The command name and the arguments typed are in the Line Buffer area (see Memory Map). The Line Buffer Pointer, on entry to the command, is pointing to the first character of the first argument, if one exists. If there are no arguments, the Line Buffer Pointer is pointing to either an end-of-line character or a carriage return. The DOS routines NXTCH, GETFIL, and GETHEX should be used by the command for processing the arguments.

Processing Errors.

If the command, while executing, receives an error status from either DOS or FMS of such a nature that the command must be aborted, the program should jump to the Warmstart Entry Point of DOS after issuing an appropriate error message. Similarly, if the command should detect an error on its own, it should issue a message and return to DOS through the Warmstart Entry Point.

EXAMPLES OF USING DOS ROUTINES

1. Setting up a file spec in the FCB can be done in the following manner. This example assumes the Line Buffer Pointer is pointing to the first character of a file specification, and the desired resulting file spec should default to a TXT extension.

```
LDX    #FCB      Point to FCB
JSR    GETFIL    Get file spec into FCB
BCS    ERROR     Report error if one
LDA    #1        Set extension code (TXT)
JSR    SETEXT    Set the default extension
```

The user may now open the file for the desired action, since the file spec is correctly set up in the FCB. Refer to the FMS examples for opening files.

2. The following examples demonstrate some simple uses of the basic I/O functions provided by DOS.

```
LDA    #'A       Setup an ASCII A
JSR    PUTCHR    Call DOS out character

LDX    #STRING    Point to string
JSR    PSTRNG    Print CR & LF + string
```

The above simple examples are to show the basic mechanism for calling and using DOS I/O routines.

THE FILE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

The File Management System (FMS), forms the communication link between the DOS and the actual Disk Hardware. The FMS performs all file allocation and removal on the disk. All file space is allocated dynamically, and the space used by files is immediately reusable upon that file's deletion. The user of the FMS need not be concerned with the actual location of a file on the disk, or how many sectors it requires.

Communication with the FMS is done through File Control Blocks. These blocks contain the information about a file, such as its name and what drive it exists on. All disk I/O performed through FMS is "one character at a time" I/O. This means that programs need only send or request a single character at a time while doing file data transfers. In effect, the disk looks no different than a computer terminal. Files may be opened for either reading or writing. Any number of files may be opened at any one time, as long as each one is assigned its own File Control Block.

The FMS is a command language whose commands are represented by various numbers called Function Codes. Each Function Code tells FMS to perform a specific function such as open a file for read, or delete a file. In general, making use of the various functions which the FMS offers, is quite simple. The index register is made to point to the File Control Block which is to be used, the Function Code is stored in the first byte of the File Control Block, and FMS is called as a subroutine (JSR). At no time does the user ever have to be concerned with where the file is being located on the disk, how long it is, or where its directory entry is located. The FMS does all of this automatically.

Since the file structure of FLEX is a linked structure, and the disk space is allocated dynamically, it is possible for a file to exist on the disk in a set of non-contiguous sectors. Normally, if a disk has just been formatted, a file will use consecutive sectors on the disk. As files are created and deleted, however, the disk may become "fragmented". Fragmentation results in the sectors on the disk becoming out of order physically, even though logically they are still all sequential. This is a characteristic of "linked list" structures and dynamic file allocation methods. The user need not be concerned with this fragmentation, but should be aware of the fact that files may exist whose sectors seem to be spattered all over the disk. The only result of fragmentation is the slowing down of file read times, because of the increased number of head seeks necessary while reading the file.

THE FILE CONTROL BLOCK (FCB)

The FCB is the heart of the FLEX File Management System (FMS). An FCB is a 320 byte long block of RAM, in the user's program area, which is used by programs to communicate with FMS. A separate FCB is needed for each open file. After a file has been closed, the FCB may be re-used to open another file or to perform some other disk function such as Delete or Rename. An FCB may be placed anywhere in the user's program area (except page zero) that the programmer wishes. The memory reserved for use as an FCB need not be preset or initialized in any way. Only the parameters necessary to perform the function need be stored in the FCB; the File Management System will initialize those areas of the FCB needed for its use.

In the following description of an FCB, the byte numbers are relative to the beginning of the FCB; i.e. byte 0 is the first byte of the FCB.

DESCRIPTION OF AN FCB

Byte 0 Function Code

The desired function code must be stored in this byte by the user before calling FMS to process the FCB. See the section describing FMS Function Codes.

Byte 1 Error Status Byte

If an error was detected during the processing of a function, FMS stores the error number in this byte and returns to the user with the CPU Z-Condition Code bit clear, i.e. a non-zero condition exists. This may be tested by the BEQ or BNE instruction.

Byte 2 Activity Status

This byte is set by FMS to a "1" if the file is open for read, or "2" if the file is open for writing. This byte is checked by several FMS function processors to determine if the requested operation is legal. A Status Error is returned for illegal operations.

The next 12 bytes (3-14) comprise the "File Specification" of the file being referenced by the FCB. A "File Specification" consists of a drive number, file name, and file extension. Some of the FMS functions do not require the file name or extension. See the documentation of the individual function codes for details.

Byte 3 Drive Number

This is the hardware drive number whose diskette contains the file being referenced. It should be binary 0 to 3.

The next 24 bytes (4-27) comprise the "Directory Information" portion of the FCB. This is the exact same information which is contained in the diskette directory entry for the file being referenced.

Bytes 4-11 File Name

This is the name of the file being referenced. The name must start with a letter and contain only letters, digits, hyphens, and/or underscores. If the name is less than 8 characters long, the remaining bytes must be zero. The name should be left adjusted in its field.

Bytes 12-14 Extension

This is the extension of the file name for the file being referenced. It must start with a letter and contain only letters, digits, hyphens, and/or underscores. If the extension is less than 3 characters long, the remaining bytes must be zero. The extension should be left adjusted. Files with null extensions should not be created.

Byte 15 File Attributes

At present, only the most significant 4 bits are defined in this byte. These bits are used for the protection status bits and are assigned as follows:

- BIT 7 = Write Protect
- BIT 6 = Delete Protect
- BIT 5 = Read Protect
- BIT 4 = Catalog Protect

Setting these bits to 1 will activate the appropriate protection status. All undefined bits of this byte should remain 0!

Byte 16 Reserved for future system use

Bytes 17-18 Starting disk address of the file

These two bytes contain the hardware track and sector numbers, respectively, of the first sector of the file.

Bytes 19-20 Ending disk address of the file

These two bytes contain the hardware track and sector numbers, respectively, of the last sector of the file.

Bytes 21-22 File Size

This is a 16-bit number indicating the number of sectors in the file.

FLEX Advanced Programmer's Guide

Byte 23 File Sector Map Indicator

If this byte is non-zero (usually \$02), the file has been created as a random access file and contains a File Sector Map. See the description of Random Files for details.

Byte 24 Reserved for future system use

Bytes 25-27 File Creation Date

These three bytes contain the binary date of the files creation. The first byte is the month, the second is the day, and the third is the year (only the tens and ones digits).

Bytes 28-29 FCB List Pointer

All FCBs which are open for reading or writing are chained together. These two bytes contain the memory address of the FCB List Pointer bytes of the next FCB in the chain. These bytes are zero if this FCB is the last FCB in the chain. The first FCB in the chain is pointed to by the FCB Base Pointer. (See Global Variables).

Bytes 30-31 Current Position

These bytes contain the hardware track and sector numbers, respectively, of the sector currently in the sector buffer portion of the FCB. If the file is being written, the sector to which these bytes point has not yet been written to the diskette; it is still in the buffer.

Bytes 32-33 Current Record Number

These bytes contain the current logical Record Number of the sector in the FCB buffer.

Byte 34 Data Index

This byte contains the address of the next data byte to be fetched from (if reading) or stored into (if writing) the sector buffer. This address is relative to the beginning of the sector, and is advanced automatically by the Read/Write Next Byte function. The user program has no need to manipulate this byte.

Byte 35 Random Index

This byte is used in conjunction with the Get Random Byte from Sector function to read a specific byte from the sector buffer without having to sequentially skip over any intervening bytes. The address of the desired byte, relative to the beginning of the sector, is stored in Random Index by the user, and the Get Random Byte From Sector function is issued to FMS. The specified data byte will be returned in the A-register. A value less than 4 will

access one of the linkage bytes in the sector. User data starts at an index value of 4.

Bytes 36-46 Name Work Buffer

These bytes are used internally by FMS as temporary storage for a file name. These locations are not for use by a user program.

Bytes 47-49 Current Directory Address

If the FCB is being used to process directory information with the Get/Put Information Record functions, these three bytes contain the track number, sector number, and starting data index of the directory entry whose content is in the Directory Information portion of the FCB. The values in these three bytes are updated automatically by the Get Information Record function.

Bytes 50-52 First Deleted Directory Pointer

These bytes are used internally by FMS when looking for a free entry in the directory to which to assign the name of a new file.

Bytes 53-63 Scratch Bytes

These are the bytes into which the user stores the new name and extension of a file being renamed. The new name is formatted the same as described above under File Name and File Extension.

Byte 59 Space Compression Flag

If a file is open for read or write, this byte indicates if space compression is being performed. A value of zero indicates that space compression is to be done when reading or writing the data. This is the value that is stored by the Open for Read and Open for Write functions. A value of \$FF indicates that no space compression is to be done. This value is what the user must store in this byte, after opening the file, if space compression is not desired. (Such as for binary files). A positive non-zero value in this byte indicates that space compression is currently in progress; the value being a count of the number of spaces processed thus far. (Note that although this byte overlaps the Scratch Bytes described above, there is no conflict since the Space Compression Flag is used only when a file is open, and the Scratch Bytes are used only by Rename, which requires that the file be closed). In general, this byte should be 0 while working with text type files, and \$FF for binary files.

Bytes 64-319 Sector Buffer

These bytes contain the data contained in the sector being read or written. The first four bytes of the sector are used by the system. The remaining 252 are used for data storage.

FILE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM - Entry Points

\$D400 - FMS Initialization

This entry point is used by the DOS portion of FLEX to initialize the File Management System after a coldstart. There should be no need for a user-written program to use this entry point. Executing an FMS Initialization at the wrong time may result in the destruction of data files, necessitating a re-initialization of the diskette.

\$D403 - FMS Close

This entry point is used by the DOS portion of FLEX at the end of each command line to close any files left open by the command processor. User-written programs may also use this entry point to close all open files; however, if an error is detected in trying to close a file, any remaining files will not be closed. Thus the programmer is cautioned against using this routine as a substitute for the good programming practice of closing files individually. There are no arguments to this routine. It is entered by a JSR instruction as though it were a subroutine. On exit, the CPU Z-Condition code is set if no error was detected (i.e. a "zero" condition exists). If an error was detected, the CPU Z-Condition code bit is clear and the X-register contains the address of the FCB causing the error.

\$D406 - FMS Call

This entry point is used for all other calls to the File Management System. A function code is stored in the Function Code byte of the FCB, the address of the FCB is put in the X-register, and this entry point is called by a JSR instruction. The function codes are documented elsewhere in this document. On exit from this entry point, the CPU Z-Condition code bit is set if no error was detected in processing the function. This bit may be tested with a BEQ or BNE instruction. If an error was detected, the CPU Z-Condition code bit is cleared and the Error Status byte in the FCB contains the error number. Under all circumstances, the address of the FCB is still in the X-register on exit from this entry point. Some of the functions require additional parameters in the A and/or B-registers. See the documentation of the Function codes for details. The B,X,Y and U registers are always preserved with a call to FMS.

GLOBAL VARIABLES

This section describes those variables within the File Management System which may be of interest to the programmer. Any other locations in the FMS area should not be used for data storage by user programs.

\$D409 - \$D40A FCB Base Pointer

These locations contain the address of the FCB List Pointer bytes of the first FCB in the chain of open files. The address in these locations is managed by FMS and the programmer should not store any values in these locations. A user program may, however, want to chain through the FCBs of the open files for some reason, and the address stored in these locations is the proper starting point. Remember that the address is that of the FCB List Pointer locations in the FCB, not the first word of the FCB. A value of zero in these locations indicates that there are no open files.

\$D40B - \$D40C Current FCB Address

These locations contain the address of the last FCB processed by the File Management System. The address is that of the first word of the FCB.

\$D435 Verify Flag

A non-zero value in this location indicates that FMS will check each sector written for errors immediately after writing it. A zero value indicates that no error checking on writes is to be performed. The default value is "non-zero".

FMS FUNCTION CODES

The FLEX File Management System is utilized by the user through function codes. The proper function code number is placed, by the user, in the Function Code byte of the File Control Block (FCB) before calling FMS (Byte 0). FMS should be called by a JSR to the "FMS Call" entry. On entry to FMS, the X-register should contain the address of the FCB. On exit from FMS, the CPU Z-Condition code bit will be clear if an error was detected while processing the function. This bit may be tested by the BNE and BEQ instructions. Note: In the following examples, the line "JSR FMS" is referencing the FMS Call entry at \$D406.

Function 0 - Read/Write Next Byte/Character

If the file is open for reading, the next byte is fetched from the file and returned to the calling program in the A-register. If the file is open for writing, the content of the A-register on entry is placed in the buffer as the next byte to be written to the file. The Compression Mode Flag must contain the proper value for automatic space compression to take place, if desired (see Description of the FCB, Compression Mode Flag for details). On exit, this function code remains unchanged in the Function Code byte of the FCB; thus, consecutive read/writes may be performed without having to repeatedly store the function code. When reading, an End-of-File error is returned when all data in the file has been read. When the current sector being read is empty, the next sector in the file is prepared for processing automatically, without any action being required of the user. Similarly, when writing, full sectors are automatically written to the disk without user intervention.

Example:

If reading -

```
LDX  #FCB    Point to the FCB
JSR   FMS     Call FMS
BNE   ERROR   Check for error
The character read is now in A.
```

If writing -

```
LDA   CHAR    Get the character
LDX   #FCB    Point to the FCB
JSR   FMS     Call FMS
BNE   ERROR   Check for errors
The character in A has been written
```


Function 1 - Open for Read

The file specified in the FCB is opened for read-only access. If the file cannot be found, an error is returned. The only parts of the FCB which must be preset by the programmer before issuing this function are the file specification parts (drive number, file name, and file extension) and the function code. The remaining parts of the FCB will be initialized by the Open process. The Open process sets the File Compression Mode Flag to zero, indicating a text file. If the file is binary, the programmer should set the File Compression Mode Flag to \$FF, after opening the file, to disable the space compression feature. On exit from FMS, after opening a file, the function code in the FCB is automatically set to zero (Read/Write Next Byte Function) in anticipation of I/O on the file.

Example:

```
LDX    #FCB      Point to the FCB
[ Set up file spec in FCB ]
LDA    #1        Set open function code
STA    0,X       Store in FCB
JSR    FMS       Call FMS
BNE    ERROR     Check for errors
The file is now open for text reading
```

```
To set for binary - continue with the following
LDA    #$FF      Set FF for sup. flag
STA    59,X      Store in suppression flag
```

Function 2 - Open for Write

This is the same as Function 1, Open for Read, except that the file must not already exist in the diskette directory, and it is opened for write-only access. A file opened for write may not be read unless it is first closed and then re-opened for read-only. The space compression flag should be treated the same as described in "Open for Read". A file is normally opened as a sequential file but may be created as a random file by setting the FCB location File Sector Map byte non-zero immediately following an open for write operation. Refer to the section on Random Files for more details. The file will be created on the drive specified unless the drive spec is \$FF in which case the file will be created on the first drive found to be ready.

Example:

```
LDX    #FCB      Point to FCB
[ Setup file spec in FCB ]
LDA    #2        Setup open for write code
STA    0,X       Store in FCB
JSR    FMS       Call FMS
BNE    ERROR     Check for errors
File is now open for text write.
For binary write, follow example in Read open.
```

Function 3 - Open for Update

This function opens the file for both read and write. The file must not be open and must exist on the specified drive. If the drive spec is \$FF, all drives will be searched. Once the file has been opened for update, four operations may be performed on it; 1. sequential read, 2. random read, 3. random write, and 4. Close file. Note that it is not possible to do sequential writes to a file open for update. This implies that it is not possible to increase the size of a file which is open for update.

Function 4 - Close File

If the file was opened for reading, a close merely removes the FCB from the chain of open files. If the file was opened for writing, any data remaining in the buffer is first written to the disk, padding with zeroes if necessary, to fill out the sector. If a file was opened for writing but never written upon, the name of the file is removed from the diskette directory since the file contains no data.

Example:

```
LDX  #FCB    Point to FCB
LDA  #4      Setup close code
STA  0,X     Store in FCB
JSR  FMS     Call FMS
BNE  ERROR   Check for errors
File has now been closed.
```

Function 5 - Rewind File

Only files which have been opened for read may be rewound. On exit from FMS, the function code in the FCB is set to zero, anticipating a read operation on the file. If the programmer wishes to rewind a file which is open for writing so that it may now be read, the file must first be closed, then re-opened for reading.

Example:

```
Assuming the file is open for read:
LDX  #FCB    Point to FCB
LDA  #5      Setup rewind code
STA  0,X     Store in FCB
JSR  FMS     Call FMS
BNE  ERROR   Check for errors
File is now rewound & ready for read
```

Function 6 - Open Directory

This function opens the directory on the diskette for access by a program. The FCB used for this function must not already be open for use by a file. On entry, the only information which must be preset in the FCB is the drive number; no file name is required. The directory entries are read by using the Get Information Record function. The Put Information Record function is used to write a directory entry. The normal Read/Write Next Byte function will not function correctly on an FCB which is opened for directory access. It is not necessary to close an FCB which has been opened for directory access after the directory manipulation is finished. The user should normally not need to access the directory.

Function 7 - Get Information Record

This function should only be issued on an FCB which has been opened with the Open Directory function. Each time the Get Information Record function is issued, the next directory entry will be loaded into the Directory Information area of the FCB (see Description of the FCB for details of the format of a directory entry). All directory entries, including deleted and unused entries are read when using this function. After an entry has been read, the FCB is said to "point" to the directory entry just read; the Current Directory Address bytes in the FCB refer to the entry just read. An End-of-File error is returned when the end of the directory is reached.

Example:

```

To get the 3rd directory entry -
LDX    #FCB      Point to FCB
LDA     DRIVE    Get the drive number
STA     3,X      Store in the FCB
LDA     #6       Setup open dir code
STA     0,X      Store in FCB
JSR     FMS      Call FMS
BNE     ERROR    Check for errors
LDB     #3       Set counter to 3
LOOP   LDA     #7      Setup get rec code
STA     0,X      Store in FCB
JSR     FMS      Call FMS
BNE     ERROR    Check for errors
DECB                    Decrement the counter
BNE     LOOP     Repeat til finished
The 3rd entry is now in the FCB

```

Function 8 - Put Information Record

This function should only be issued on an FCB which has been opened with the Open Directory function. The directory information is copied from the Directory Information portion of the FCB into the directory entry to which the FCB currently points. The directory sector just updated is then re-written automatically on the diskette to ensure that the directory is up-to-date. A user program should normally never have to write into a directory. Careless use of this function can lead to the destruction of data files, necessitating a re-initialization of the diskette.

Function 9 - Read Single Sector

This function is a low-level interface directly to the disk driver which permits the reading of a single sector, to which the Current Position bytes of the FCB point, into the Sector Buffer area of the FCB. This function is normally used internally within FLEX and a user program should never need to use it. The Read/Write Next Byte function should be used instead, whenever possible. Extreme care should be taken when using this function since it does not conform to the usual conventions to which most of the other FLEX functions adhere.

Example:

```
LDX    #FCB      Point to FCB
LDA     TRACK     Get track number
STA     30,X      Set current track
LDA     SECTOR    Get sector number
STA     31,X      Set current sector
LDA     #9        Setup function code
STA     0,X       Store in FCB
JSR     FMS       Call FMS
BNE     ERROR     Check for errors
The sector is now in the FCB
```

Function 10 (\$0A hex) - Write Single Sector

This function, like the Read Single Sector function, is a low-level interface directly to the disk driver which permits the writing of a single sector. As such, it requires extreme care in its use. This function is normally used internally by FLEX, and a user program should never need to use it. The Read/Write Next Byte function should be used whenever possible. Careless use of the Write Single Sector Function may result in the destruction of data, necessitating the re-initialization of the diskette. The disk address being written is taken from the Current Position bytes of the FCB; the data is taken from the FCB Sector Buffer. This function honors the Verify Flag (see Global Variables section for a description of the Verify Flag), and will check the sector after writing it if directed to do so by the Verify Flag.

Function 11 (\$0B hex) - Reserved for future system use

Function 12 (\$0C hex) - Delete File

This function deletes the file whose specification is in the FCB (drive numbers, file name, and extension). The sectors used by the file are released to the system for re-use. The file should not be open when this function is issued. The file specification in the FCB is altered during the delete process.

Example:

```
LDX    #FCB    Point to FCB
[ setup file spec in FCB ]
LDA    #12     Setup function code
STA    0,X     Store in FCB
JSR    FMS     Call FMS
BNE    ERROR   Check errors
File has now been deleted
```

Function 13 (\$0D hex) - Rename File

On entry, the file must not be open, the old name must be in the File Specification area of the FCB, and the new name and extension must be in the Scratch Bytes area of the FCB. The file whose specification is in the FCB is renamed to the name and extension stored in the FCB Scratch Bytes area. Both the new name and the new extension must be specified; neither the name nor the extension can be defaulted.

Example:

```
LDX    #FCB    Point to FCB
[ setup both file specs in FCB ]
LDA    #13     Setup function code
STA    0,X     Store in FCB
JSR    FMS     Call FMS
BNE    ERROR   Check for errors
File has been renamed
```

Function 14 (\$0E hex) - Reserved for future system use.

Function 15 (\$0F hex) - Next Sequential Sector

On entry the file should be open for either reading or writing (not update). If the file is open for reading, this function code will cause all of the remaining (yet unread) data bytes in the current sector to be skipped, and the data pointer will be positioned at the first data byte of the next sequential sector of the file. If the file is open for write, this operation will cause the remainder of the current sector to be zero filled and written out to the disk. The next character written to that file will be placed in the first available data location in the next sequential sector. It should be noted that all calls to this function code will be ignored unless at least one byte of data has either been written or read from the current sector.

Function 16 (\$10 hex) - Open System Information Record

On entry, only the drive number need be specified in the FCB; there is no file name associated with this function. The FCB must not be open for use by a file. This function accesses the System Information Record for the diskette whose drive number is in the FCB. There are no separate functions for reading or changing this sector. All references to the data contained in the System Information Record must be made by manipulating the Sector Buffer directly. This function is used internally within FLEX; there should be no need for a user-written program to change the System Information Record. Doing so may result in the destruction of data, necessitating the re-initialization of the diskette. There is no need to close the FCB when finished.

Function 17 (\$11 hex) - Get Random Byte From Sector

On entry, the file should be open for reading or update. Also, the desired byte's number should be stored in the Random Index byte of the FCB. This byte number is relative to the beginning of the sector buffer. On exit, the byte whose number is stored in the Random Index is returned to the calling program in the A-register. The Random Index should not be less than 4 since there is no user data in the first four bytes of the sector.

Example:

```
To read the 54th data byte of the current sector -
LDX  #FCB      Point to the FCB
LDA  #54+4     Set to item + 4
STA  35,X      Put it in random index
LDA  #17       Setup function code
STA  0,X       Store in FCB
JSR  FMS       Call FMS
BNE  ERROR     Check for errors
Character is now in acc. A
```

Function 18 (\$12 hex) - Put Random Byte in Sector

The file must be open for update. This function is similar to Get Random Byte except the character in the A accumulator is written into the sector at the data location specified by Random Index of the FCB. The Random Index should not be less than 4 since only system data resides in the first 4 bytes of the sector.

Example:

```

To write into the 54th data byte of the current sector-
LDX  #FCB      Point to the FCB
LDA  #54+4     Set to item + 4
STA  35,X      Put it in Random Index
LDA  #18       Setup Function Code
STA  0,X       Store in FCB
LDA  CHAR      Get character to be written
JSR  FMS       Call FMS
BNE  ERROR     Check for errors
Character has been written

```

Function 19 (\$13 hex) - Reserved for future system use

Function 20 (\$14 hex) - Find Next Drive

This function is used to find the next online drive which is in the "ready" state. Due to hardware limitations, the minifloppy version of FLEX performs this command differently than the full size floppy version. The functioning of the full size floppy version is as follows. If the drive number in the FCB is hex FF, the search for drives will start with drive 0. If the drive number is 0, 1, or 2, the search will start with drive 1, 2, or 3 respectively. If a ready drive is found, its drive number will be returned in the drive number byte of the FCB and the carry bit will be cleared. If no ready drive is found, the carry bit will be set and error #16 (Drives Not Ready) will be set.

The minifloppy version functions as follows. If called with a Drive Number in the FCB of hex FF, the function will return with 0 as the drive number in the FCB. If called with a 0, it will return with the drive number set to 1. In both cases the carry is cleared on return. If called with a drive number of 1 or higher, the drive number is left unchanged, the carry bit is set on return and error #16 (Drives Not Ready) is set.

Function 21 (\$15 hex) - Position to Record N

This is one of the 2 function codes provided for random file accessing by sector. The desired record number to be accessed should be stored in the FCB location Current Record Number (a 16 bit binary value). The file must be open for read or update before using this function code. The first data record of a file is record number one. Positioning to record 0 will read in the first sector of the File Sector Map. After a successful Position operation, the first character read with a sequential read will be the first data byte of the specified record. An attempt to position to a nonexistent record will cause an error. For more information on random files, see the section titled 'Random Files'.

Example:

```
To position to record #6 -
LDX  #FCB      Point to the FCB
LDA  #6         Set position
STA  33,X      Put in FCB
CLR  32,X      Set M.S.B to 0
LDA  #21       Setup Function Code
STA  0,X       Store in FCB
JSR  FMS       Call FMS
BNE  ERROR     Check for errors
Record ready to be read
```

Function 22 (\$16 hex) - Backup One Record

This is also used for random file accessing. This function takes the Current Record Number in the FCB and decrements it by one. A Position to the new record is performed. This has the effect of back spacing one full record. For example, if the Current Record Number is 16 and the Backup One Record function is performed, the file would be positioned to read the first byte of record #15. The file must be open for read or update before this function may be used. See 'Random Files' section for more details.

RANDOM FILES

FLEX version 9.0 supports random files. The random access technique allows access by record number of a file and can reach any specified sector in a file, no matter how large it is, in a maximum of two disk reads. With a small calculation using the number of data bytes in a sector (252), the user may also easily reach the Nth character of a file using the same mechanism.

Not all files may be accessed in a random manner. It is necessary to create the file as a random file. The default creation mode is sequential and is what all of the standard FLEX Utilities work with. The only random file in a standard FLEX system is the ERRORS.SYS file. FLEX uses a random access technique when reporting error messages. A file which has been created as a random access file may read either randomly or sequentially. A sequential file may only be read sequentially.

To create a random file, the normal procedure for opening a file for write should be used. Immediately following a successful open, set the File Sector Map location of the FCB to any non-zero value and proceed with the file's creation. It only makes sense to create text type files in the random mode. As the file is built, the system creates a File Sector Map. This File Sector Map (FSM) is a map or directory which tells the system where each record (sector) of the file is located on the disk. The FSM is always two sectors in length and is assigned record number 0 in the file. This implies that a data file requiring 5 sectors for the data will actually be 7 sectors in length. The user has no need for the FSM sectors and they are automatically skipped when opening a file for read. The FMS uses them for the Position and Backup function code operations.

The directory information of a file states whether or not a file is a random file. If the File Sector Map byte is non-zero, the file is random, otherwise it is sequential only. It should be noted that random files can be Copied from one disk to another without losing its random properties, but it can not be appended to another file.

FLEX ERROR NUMBERS

- 1 - ILLEGAL FMS FUNCTION CODE ENCOUNTERED
FMS was called with a function code in the Function Code byte of the FCB that was too large or illegal.
- 2 - THE REQUESTED FILE IS IN USE
An Open for Read, Update, or Write function was issued on an FCB that is already open.
- 3 - THE FILE SPECIFIED ALREADY EXISTS
 - a. An Open for Write was issued on an FCB containing the specification for a file already existing in the diskette directory.
 - b. A Rename function was issued specifying a new name that was the same as the name of a file already existing in the diskette directory.
- 4 - THE SPECIFIED FILE COULD NOT BE FOUND
An Open for Read or Update, a Rename, or a Delete function was requested on an FCB containing the file specification for a file which does not exist in the diskette directory.
- 5 - SYSTEM DIRECTORY ERROR - REBOOT SYSTEM
Reserved for future system use.
- 6 - THE SYSTEM DIRECTORY SPACE IS FULL
This error should never occur since the directory space is self expanding, and can never be filled. Only disk space can be filled (error #7).
- 7 - ALL AVAILABLE DISK SPACE HAS BEEN USED
All of the available space on the diskette has been used up by files. If this error is returned by FMS, the last character sent to be written to a file did not actually get written.
- 8 - READ PAST END OF FILE
A read operation on a file encountered an end-of-file. All of the data in the file has been processed. This error will also be returned when reading a directory with the Get Information Record function when the end of the directory is reached.
- 9 - DISK FILE READ ERROR
A checksum error was encountered by the hardware in attempting to read a sector. DOS has already attempted to re-read the failing sector several times, without success, before reporting the error. This error may also result from illegal track and sector addresses being put in the FCB.

- 10 - DISK FILE WRITE ERROR
A checksum error was detected by the hardware in attempting to write a sector. DOS has already tried several times, without success, to re-write the failing sector before reporting the error. This error may also result from illegal track and sector numbers being put in the FCB. A write-error status may also be returned if a read error was detected by DOS in attempting to update the diskette directory.
- 11 - THE FILE OR DISK IS WRITE PROTECTED
An attempt was made to write on a diskette which has been write-protected by use of the write-enable cutout in the diskette or to a file which has the write protect bit set.
- 12 - THE FILE IS PROTECTED - FILE NOT DELETED
The file attempted to be deleted has its delete protect bit set and can not be deleted.
- 13 - ILLEGAL FILE CONTROL BLOCK SPECIFIED
An attempt was made to access an FCB from the open FCB chain, but it was not in the chain.
- 14 - ILLEGAL DISK ADDRESS ENCOUNTERED
Reserved for future system use.
- 15 - AN ILLEGAL DRIVE NUMBER WAS SPECIFIED
Reserved for future system use.
- 16 - DRIVES NOT READY
The drive does not have a diskette in it or the door is open. This message cannot be issued for mini floppys since there is no means of detecting such a state.
- 17 - THE FILE IS PROTECTED - ACCESS DENIED
Reserved for future system use.
- 18 - SYSTEM FILE STATUS ERROR
 - a. A read or Rewind was attempted on a file which was closed, or open for write access.
 - b. A write was attempted on a file which was closed, or open for read access.
- 19 - FMS DATA INDEX RANGE ERROR
The Get Random Byte from Sector function was issued with a Random Byte number greater than 255.
- 20 - FMS INACTIVE - REBOOT SYSTEM
Reserved for future system use.
- 21 - ILLEGAL FILE SPECIFICATION
A format error was detected in a file name specification. The name must begin with a letter and contain only letters, digits, hyphens, and/or underscores. Similarly with file extensions. File names are limited to 8 characters, extensions to 3.

- 22 - SYSTEM FILE CLOSE ERROR
Reserved for future system use.
- 23 - SECTOR MAP OVERFLOW - DISK TOO SEGMENTED
An attempt was made to create a very large random access file on a disk which is very segmented. All record information could not fit in the 2 sectors of the File Sector Map. Recreating the file on a new diskette will solve the problem.
- 24 - NON-EXISTENT RECORD NUMBER SPECIFIED
A record number larger than the last record number of the file was specified in a random position access.
- 25 - RECORD NUMBER MATCH ERROR - FILE DAMAGED
The record located by the FMS random search is not the correct record. The file is probably damaged.
- 26 - COMMAND SYNTAX ERROR - RETYPE COMMAND
The command line just typed has a syntax error.
- 27 - THAT COMMAND IS NOT ALLOWED WHILE PRINTING
The command just entered is not allowed to operate while the system printer spooler is activated.
- 28 - WRONG HARDWARE CONFIGURATION
This error usually implies insufficient memory installed in the computer for a particular function or trying to use the printer spooler without the hardware timer board installed.

DISK DRIVERS

The following information is for those users who wish to write their own disk drivers to interface with some other disk configuration than is supplied by the vendor. Technical Systems Consultants is not in a position to write disk drivers for other configurations, nor do they guarantee the proper functioning of FLEX with user-written drivers.

The disk drivers are the interface routines between FLEX and the hardware driving the floppy disks themselves. The drivers released with the FLEX System are designed to interface with the Western Digital 1771 or 1791 Floppy Disk Formatter/Controller chip.

The disk drivers are located in RAM at addresses \$DE00 - \$DFA0. All disk functions are vectored jumps at the beginning of this area. The disk drivers need not handle retries in case of errors; FLEX will call them as needed. If an error is detected, the routines should exit with the disk hardware status in the B-register and the CPU Z-Condition code bit clear (issue a TST B before returning to accomplish this). FLEX expects status responses as produced by the Western Digital 1771 Controller. These statuses must be simulated if some other controller is used. All drivers should return with the X,Y and U registers unchanged. All routines are entered with a JSR instruction.

\$DE00 - Read

Entry - (X) = FCB Sector Buffer Address
 (A) = Track Number
 (B) = Sector Number

The sector referenced by the track and sector numbers is to be read into the Sector Buffer area of the indicated FCB.

\$DE03 - Write

Entry - (X) = FCB Sector Buffer Address
 (A) = Track Number
 (B) = Sector Number

The content of the Sector Buffer area of the indicated FCB is to be written to the sector referenced by the track and sector numbers.

\$DE06 - Verify

Entry - (No parameters)

The sector just written is to be verified to determine if there are CRC errors.

\$DE09 - Restore

Entry - (X) = FCB Address
 Exit - CC, NE, & B=\$B if write protected
 CS, NE, & B=\$F if no drive

A Restore Operation (also known as a Seek to Track 00) is to be performed on the drive whose number is in the FCB.

FLEX Advanced Programmer's Guide

\$DEOC - Drive Select

Entry - (X) = FCB Address

The drive whose number is in the FCB is to be selected.

\$DEOF - Check Drive Ready

Entry - (X) = FCB Address

Exit - NE & CS if drive not ready

EQ & CC if drive ready

This routine is setup for FLEX systems where it is possible to check the drive whose number is in the FCB for a ready status after selecting that drive and delaying long enough for the drive motor to come up to speed (approx. 2 seconds). This is not possible in the minifloppy version due to hardware limitations. In this case, this routine should not delay and should simply return a drive ready status if the drive number in the FCB is 0 or 1 or a drive not ready status for any other drive number.

\$DE12 - Quick Check Drive Ready

This routine is the same as Drive Check Ready except the 2 second delay is not done. This assumes the drive motor is already up to speed. For minifloppy versions, there is no difference in the two and this routine can simply be a jump to the Check Drive Ready routine.

Diskette Initialization

The NEWDISK command is used to "initialize" a diskette for use by the FLEX Operating System. The initialization process writes the necessary track and sector addresses in the sectors of a "soft- sectored" diskette such as is used by FLEX. In addition, the initialization process links together all of the sectors on the diskette into a chain of available sectors.

The first track on the diskette, track 0, is special. None of the sectors on track 0 are available for data files, they are reserved for use by the FLEX system. The first two sectors contain a "boot" program which is loaded by the "D" command of the SBUG monitor or by whatever comparable ROM based bootstrap is in use. The boot program, once loaded, then loads FLEX from the diskette. Another sector on track 0 is the System Information Record. This sector contains the track and sector addresses of the beginning and ending sectors of the chain of free sectors, those available for data files. The rest of track 0 is used for the directory of file names.

After initialization, the free tracks on the diskette have a common format. The first two bytes of each sector contain the track and sector number of the next sector in the chain. The next two bytes are used to store the logical record number of the sector in the file. The remaining 252 bytes are zero. Initially, all record number bytes are zero. When data is stored in a file, the two linkage bytes at the beginning of each sector are modified to point to the next sector in the file, not the next sector in the free chain. The sectors in the diskette directory on track 0 also have linkage bytes similar to those in the free chain and data files.

A FLEX diskette is not initialized in the strict IBM standard format. In the standard format, the sectors on the diskette should be physically in the same order as they are logically, i.e. sector 2 should follow sector 1, 3 follow 2, etc. On a FLEX diskette, the sectors are interleaved so that there is time, after having read one sector, to process the data and request the next sector before it has passed under the head. If the sectors are physically adjacent, the processing time must be very short. The interleaving of the sectors allows more time for processing the data. The phenomena of missing a sector because of long processing times is called "missing revolutions", and results in very slow running time for programs. The FLEX format reduces the number of missed revolutions, thus speeding up programs.

DESCRIPTION OF A DIRECTORY SECTOR

Each sector in the directory portion of a FLEX diskette contains 10 directory entries. Each entry refers to one file on the diskette. In each sector, the first four bytes contain the sector linkage information and the next 12 bytes are not used. When reading information from the directory using the FMS Get Information Record function, these 16 bytes are skipped automatically as each sector is read; the user need not be concerned with them.

Each entry in the directory contains the exact same information that is stored in the FCB bytes 4-27. See the description of the File Control Block (FCB) for more details.

A directory entry which has never been used has a zero in the first byte of the file name. A directory entry which has been deleted has the leftmost bit of the name set (i.e. the first byte of the name is negative).

DESCRIPTION OF A DATA SECTOR

Every sector on a FLEX diskette (except the two BOOT sectors) has the following format:

- Bytes 0-1 Link to the next sector
- Bytes 2-3 File Logical Record Number
- Bytes 4-255 Data

If a file occupies more than one sector, the "link to the next sector" portion contains the track and sector numbers, respectively, of the next sector in the file. These bytes are zero in the last sector of a file, indicating that no more data follows (an "end-of-file" condition). The user should never manually change the linkage bytes of a sector. These bytes are automatically managed by FMS. In fact, the user need not be concerned at all with sector linkage information.

DESCRIPTION OF A BINARY FILE

A FLEX binary file may contain anything as data; all ASCII characters are allowed. Each binary file is composed of one or more binary records. There may be more than one binary record in a single sector.

A binary record looks as follows: (byte numbers are relative to the start of the record, not the beginning of a sector)

- Byte 0 Start of record indicator (\$02, the ASCII STX)
- Byte 1 Most significant byte of the load address
- Byte 2 Least significant byte of the load address
- Byte 3 Number of data bytes in the record
- Byte 4-n The binary data in the record

The load address portion of a binary record contains the address where the data resided when it was written to the file with the FLEX SAVE command. When the file is loaded for execution or use, it will be put in the same memory areas from which it was SAVED.

A binary file may also contain an optional transfer address record. This record gives the address in memory of the entry point of a binary program. The format of a transfer address record is as follows:

- Byte 0 Transfer Address Indicator (\$16, ASCII ACK)
- Byte 1 Most significant byte of the transfer address
- Byte 2 Least significant byte of the transfer address

If a file contains more than one transfer address record (caused by appending binary files which contain transfer addresses), the last one encountered by the load process is the one that is used, the others are ignored.

When reading or writing a binary file through the File Management System from a user program, the calling program must process the record indicator bytes and load addresses itself; FLEX does not supply or process this information for the user.

DESCRIPTION OF A TEXT FILE

A text file (also called an "ASCII file" or "coded file") contains only printable ASCII characters plus a few special-purpose control characters. There is no "load address" associated with a FLEX text file as there is with FLEX binary files. It is the responsibility of the program which is reading the text file to put the data where it belongs.

The only control character which FLEX recognizes and processes in a FLEX text file are:

\$0D (ASCII CR or RETURN)

This character is used to mark the end of a line or record in the file.

\$00 (ASCII NULL)

Ignored by FLEX; if encountered in the file, it is not returned to the calling program.

\$18 (ASCII CANCEL)

Ignored by FLEX; if encountered in the file, it is not returned to the calling program.

\$09 (ASCII HT or HORIZONTAL TAB)

This is a flag character which indicates that a string of spaces has been removed from the file as a space-saving measure. The next byte following the flag character is a count of the number of space removed (2-127). The calling program sees neither the flag character nor the count character. The proper number of spaces are returned to the user program as successive characters are requested by the Read Next Byte function. When writing a file, the spaces are automatically deleted as the user program sends them to the File Management System using the Write Next Byte function. The data compression is, therefore, transparent to the calling program. (The above discussion is only valid if the file is open for Text operations. If open for Binary, the compression flag and count get passed exactly as they appear in the file.)

WRITING UTILITY COMMANDS

Utility commands are best prepared by the use of an assembler. FLEX reserves a block of memory in which medium size utilities may be placed. This memory starts at hex location \$C100 and extends through location \$C6FF. The system FCB at location \$C840 may also be used in user written utilities for either FCB space or temporary storage. No actual code should reside in this FCB space since it would interfere with the loading of the utility (FLEX is using that FCB while loading utilities).

An example will be given to demonstrate some of the conventions and techniques which should be used when writing utilities. The example, which can be found on the following pages, is a simple text file listing utility. Its syntax is:

```
LIST,[<FILE SPEC>]
```

The default extension on the file spec is TXT. The utility will simply display the contents of a text file on the terminal, line for line.

The following is a section by section description of the LIST utility. The first section of the source listing is a set of EQUATES which tell the assembler where the various DOS routines reside in memory. These equates represent the addresses given in this manual for "User Callable DOS System Routines".

The next two sections are also equates, the first to the FMS entry points, and the second references the system FCB. The actual program finally starts with the ORG statement. In this program, we will make use of the Utility Command space located at \$C100, therefore, the ORG is to \$C100.

One of the conventions which should be observed when writing DOS utilities is to always start the program with a BRA instruction. Following this instruction should be a 'VN FCB 1' which defines the version number of the utility. The 1 should of course be set to whatever the actual version number is. In this example, the version number is 1. This convention allows the FLEX VERSION Utility to correctly identify the version number of a command.

Moving down the program to the label called 'LIST2', the program needs to retrieve the file specification and get it into the FCB. Pointing X to the FCB, we can make use of the DOS resident subroutine called 'GETFIL' to automatically parse the file spec, check for errors, and set the name in the FCB correctly. If all goes well in GETFIL, the carry should be clear, otherwise there were errors in the file spec and this fact needs reported. If the carry is set, control is passed to the line with the label 'LIST9'. At this point, the error message is reported and control is returned to FLEX.

If the file spec was correct, and the carry was clear after the return from GETFIL, we want to set a default file name extension of TXT. The DOS subroutine named SETEXT will do exactly that. First it is necessary

to put the code for TXT in the A accumulator (the code is 1). X needs to be pointing to the FCB which it still is. The '1' is also put in the FCB for the future open operation. The call is made to SETEXT and the file name is now correctly set up in the FCB. Note that no errors can be generated by a call to SETEXT.

Now that we have the file spec, it is necessary to open the requested file for read. X is still pointing to the FCB so it is not necessary to reset. The FMS Function Code for 'open a file for read' is 1 which was previously put in the FCB location 0. A call to FMS is now made in an attempt to open the file. Upon return, if the Z-condition code is set, there were no errors. If there was an error, the 'BNE LIST9' will take us to the code to report the error. This section of code is the desired way to handle most FMS caused disk errors. The first thing to do is call the DOS routine RPTERR which will print the disk error message on the monitor terminal. Next, all open disk files should be closed. This can be easily accomplished by a call to the FMS close entry (FMSCLS). Finally, return control back to DOS by jumping to the WARM START entry. If the file opened successfully, control will be transferred to the line with the label 'LIST4'. At this time it is desirable to fetch characters one at a time from the file, printing them on the monitor terminal as they are received. Since line feeds are not stored in text files (carriage returns mark the end of lines, but the next line will follow immediately), each carriage return received from the file is not output as is, but instead a call to the DOS routine 'PCRLF' is made to print a carriage return and a line feed. As each character is received from the file (by a call to FMS at label LIST4), the error status is checked. If an error does occur, control is transferred to 'LIST6'. Since FLEX does not store an End of File character with a file, the only mechanism for determining the end of a file is by the End of File error generated by FMS. At 'LIST6', the error status is checked to see if it is 8 (end of file status). If it is not an 8, control is transferred to the error handling routine described above. If it is an End of File, we are finished listing the file so it must now be closed. The FMS Function Code for closing a file is 4. This is loaded into A and stored in the FCB. Calling FMS will attempt to close the file. Upon return, errors are checked, and if none found, control is transferred back to DOS by the jump to 'WARMS'.

This example illustrates many of the methods used when writing utilities. Many of the DOS and FMS routines were used. The basic idea of file opening and closing were demonstrated, as well as file I/O. The methods of dealing with various types of errors were also presented. Studying this example until it is thoroughly understood will make writing your own disk commands and disk oriented programs an easy task.

*

* SIMPLE TEXT FILE LIST UTILITY

*

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*

* TECHNICAL SYSTEMS CONSULTANTS, INC.

* DOS EQUATES

CD03	WARMS	EQU	\$CD03	DOS WARMS START ENTRY
CD2D	GETFIL	EQU	\$CD2D	GET FILE SPECIFICATION
CD18	PUTCHR	EQU	\$CD18	PUT CHARACTER ROUTINE
CD24	PCRLF	EQU	\$CD24	PRINT CR & LF
CD33	SETEXT	EQU	\$CD33	SET DEFAULT NAME EXT
CD3F	RPTERR	EQU	\$CD3F	REPORT DISK ERROR

* FMS EQUATES

D406	FMS	EQU	\$D406
D403	FMSCLS	EQU	\$D403

* SYSTEM EQUATES

C840	FCB	EQU	\$C840	SYSTEM FCB
------	-----	-----	--------	------------

* LIST UTILITY STARTS HERE

C100			ORG	\$C100	
C100	20	01	LIST	BRA	LIST2 GET AROUND TEMPS
C102	01		VN	FCB	1 VERSION NUMBER
C103	8E	C840	LIST2	LDX	#FCB POINT TO FCB
C106	BD	CD2D		JSR	GETFIL GET FILE SPEC
C109	25	34		BCS	LIST9 ANY ERRORS?
C10B	86	01		LDA	#1 SET UP CODE
C10D	A7	84		STA	0,X SAVE FOR READ OPEN
C10F	BD	CD33		JSR	SETEXT SET TXT EXTENSION
C112	BD	D406		JSR	FMS CALL FMS - DO OPEN
C115	26	28		BNE	LIST9 CHECK FOR ERROR
C117	8E	C840	LIST4	LDX	#FCB POINT TO FCB
C11A	BD	D406		JSR	FMS CALL FMS - GET CHAR
C11D	26	0E		BNE	LIST6 ERRORS?
C11F	81	0D		CMPA	#\$D IS CHAR A CR?
C121	26	05		BNE	LIST5
C123	BD	CD24		JSR	PCRLF OUTPUT CR & LF
C126	20	EF		BRA	LIST4 REPEAT
C128	BD	CD18	LIST5	JSR	PUTCHR OUTPUT THE CHARACTER
C12B	20	EA		BRA	LIST4 REPEAT SEQUENCE

FLEX Advanced Programmer's Guide

C12D	A6	01	LIST6	LDA	1,X	GET ERROR STATUS
C12F	81	08		CMPA	#8	IS IT EOF ERROR?
C131	26	0C		BNE	LIST9	
C133	86	04		LDA	#4	CLOSE FILE CODE
C135	A7	84		STA	0,X	STORE IN FCB
C137	BD	D406		JSR	FMS	CALL FMS - CLOSE FILE
C13A	26	03		BNE	LIST9	ERRORS?
C13C	7E	CD03		JMP	WARMS	RETURN TO FLEX
C13F	BD	CD3F	LIST9	JSR	RPTERR	REPORT ERROR
C142	BD	D403		JSR	FMSCLS	CLOSE ALL FILES
C145	7E	CD03		JMP	WARMS	RETURN TO FLEX
				END	LIST	

THE DOS LINK UTILITY

The LINK Utility provided with FLEX is a special purpose command. Its only function is to inform the "disk boot", which is on track 0, where the program resides which is to be loaded during the boot operation. Normally, LINK is used to set the pointer to the DOS program. Since DOS may reside anywhere on the disk, LINK takes the starting disk address of the file and stores it in a pointer in the boot sector. When the boot program is later executed, it simply takes this disk address, and loads the binary file which resides at that location. The load process is terminated upon the receipt of a transfer address record. At this time, control is transferred to the program just loaded by jumping to the address specified in the transfer address record. If the 'linked' program is ever moved on the disk, then it must be re-linked so the boot knows the new disk address.

LINK may be used in some specialized applications. One is the development of custom operating systems. The user may write his own operating system, link it to the boot, and use it exactly as FLEX is used now. It may also be desirable for special disks to boot in specialized programs rather than the operating system. If this is done, remember that unless the DOS is loaded during the boot process, there will not be any disk drivers or File Management System resident in memory.

PRINTER ROUTINES

There are two printer related programs provided with FLEX. One is the P Utility, the other is the PRINT.SYS file which is the actual set of printer drivers (initialize printer and output character). The P command source listing is provided on the following pages and should be self explanatory. Below you will find the requirements of the PRINT.SYS file. No source listing is provided here since one is given in the "FLEX User's Manual".

'PRINT.SYS' FILE REQUIREMENTS

The PRINT.SYS file needs to provide the system with three basic printer routines, one for printer port initialization, one for printer status, and one for output character to printer routine. The P routine and the system printer spooler use these routines to communicate with the printer. A source listing of the provided routines are included in the "FLEX User's Manual" and will not be duplicated here. The three routines and their requirements are listed here.

PINIT	(\$CCC0-CCD7) This routine should initialize the printer port. No registers need be preserved.
PCHK	(\$CCD8-CCE3) This routine should check to see if the printer can accept another character. Return Negative CC status if can accept, Plus if can not. Preserve A, B, X, Y, and U.
POUT	(\$CCE4-CCF7) This routine should output the character in A after calling PCHK to verify the printer can accept the character. Preserve B, X, Y, and U.

THE SYSTEM PRINTER SPOOLER

FLEX contains a printer spooler module. It requires the installation of an interval timer board for operation. Essentially, the spooler is a multi-tasking system, with the output to printer function being a low priority task. Any requested disk service will cause the printer task to temporarily halt until the disk has been used. It should be noted that the SWI3 CPU vector is adjusted in this task scheduler. The PRINT command is used to activate the spooler which in turn prints the files (if any) in the print queue. Exact details of the spooling operation are not available at this time.

FLEX Advanced Programmer's Guide

*
 * "P" UTILITY COMMAND
 *
 * THE P COMMAND INITIALIZES A PORT AND
 * CHANGES THE OUTCH JUMP VECTOR IN FLEX
 *

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 *
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* EQUATES

C840	FCB	EQU	\$C840
CD30	LOAD	EQU	\$CD30
D406	FMS	EQU	\$D406
D403	FMSCLS	EQU	\$D403
CD06	RENTERR	EQU	\$CD06
0004	NFER	EQU	\$4
CC09	PAUSE	EQU	\$CC09
CD1E	PSTRNG	EQU	\$CD1E
CD3F	RPTERR	EQU	\$CD3F
CD03	WARMS	EQU	\$CD03
CC11	LSTTRM	EQU	\$CC11
CC02	EOL	EQU	\$CC02
CCC0	PINIT	EQU	\$CCC0
CCE4	POUT	EQU	\$CCE4
CD0F	OUTCH	EQU	\$CD0F
CCFC	PR1	EQU	\$CCFC

C100			ORG	\$C100
------	--	--	-----	--------

C100	20	01	P	BRA	P1	BRANCH AROUND TEMPS
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C102	01		VN	FCB	1	VERSION NUMBER
------	----	--	----	-----	---	----------------

C103	B6	CCFC	P1	LDA	PR1	CHECK SYSTEM PROCESS REG
C106	27	09		BEQ	P12	IS IT BUSY?
C108	8E	C840		LDX	#FCB	POINT TO FCB
C10B	C6	1B		LDB	#27	SET BUSY ERROR
C10D	E7	01		STB	1,X	STUFF IN FCB
C10F	20	45		BRA	P3	GO REPORT ERROR
C111	B6	CC11	P12	LDA	LSTTRM	GET LAST TERMINATOR
C114	81	0D		CMPA	#\$D	IS IT A CR?
C116	27	47		BEQ	P8	
C118	B1	CC02		CMPA	EOL	IS IT EOL CHARACTER?
C11B	27	42		BEQ	P8	
C11D	7F	CC09		CLR	PAUSE	DISABLE THE PAUSE FEATURE

- continued -

C120	B6	CCE4		LDA	POUT	GET 1ST BYTE OF SPACE
C123	81	39		CMPA	#\$39	IS IT RTS?
C125	26	14		BNE	P15	IF NOT - THEN LOADED
C127	8E	C840		LDX	#FCB	POINT TO FCB
C12A	86	01		LDA	#1	OPEN FILE FOR READ
C12C	A7	84		STA	0,X	
C12E	BD	D406		JSR	FMS	CALL FMS
C131	26	14		BNE	P2	CHECK FOR ERRORS
C133	86	FF		LDA	#\$FF	SET FOR BINARY READ
C135	A7	88 3B		STA	59,X	SET COMPRESSION FLAG
C138	BD	CD30		JSR	LOAD	CALL FLEX'S LOADER
C13B	BD	CCC0	P15	JSR	PINIT	GO INITIALIZE PORT
C13E	8E	CCE4		LDX	#POUT	GET OUTPUT ADDRESS
C141	BF	CD10		STX	OUTCH+1	STUFF IN FLEX
C144	7E	CD06		JMP	RENTER	RETURN TO FLEX
C147	A6	01	P2	LDA	1,X	GET ERROR CODE
C149	81	04		CMPA	#NFER	IS IT "NO SUCH FILE"?
C14B	26	09		BNE	P3	
C14D	30	8D 0014		LEAX	NOPST,PCR	POINT TO MESSAGE
C151	BD	CD1E	P25	JSR	PSTRNG	GO PRINT IT
C154	20	03		BRA	P4	
C156	BD	CD3F	P3	JSR	RPTERR	REPORT ERROR
C159	BD	D403	P4	JSR	FMSCLS	CLOSE ALL FILES
C15C	7E	CD03		JMP	WARMS	RETURN TO FLEX
C15F	30	8D 0018	P8	LEAX	ERSTR,PCR	POINT TO STRING
C163	20	EC		BRA	P25	GO PRINT IT
C165	22	50 52 49	NOPST	FCC	' "PRINT.SYS" NOT FOUND'	
C17A	04			FCB	4	
C17B	22	50 22 20	ERSTR	FCC	' "P" MUST BE FOLLOWED BY A COMMAND'	
C19C	04			FCB	4	

* THE FOLLOWING CODE IS LOADED INTO
 * THE SYSTEM FCB WHEN THE P COMMAND IS
 * LOADED INTO MEMORY.
 * IT PRESETS THE FILE NAME IN THE FCB.

C843			ORG	\$C843
C843	FF		FCB	\$FF
C844	50 52 49 4E		FCC	'PRINT'
C849	00 00 00		FCB	0,0,0
C84C	53 59 53		FCC	'SYS'
			END	P

INTERRUPTS IN FLEX

FLEX makes extensive use of interrupts during printer spooling. Anytime there are files in the PRINT Queue (as a result of using the PRINT command) the timer board (MP-T in I/O slot #4) is activated. This board is initialized to output interrupts every 10 milliseconds. These are IRQ type interrupts and FLEX sets the IRQ vector to point to its IRQ routine. When the PRINT Queue is empty, the timer is shut off and no interrupts are generated. The SWI3 instruction is also used quite extensively in FLEX. The SWI3 vector in RAM is set by FLEX to point to its SWI3 routine. Because of the SWI3 and IRQ use, the MON command will not permit leaving FLEX while there is a file in the PRINT Queue.

All FLEX utilities, the Editor, the Assembler, the Text Processor, and BASIC are interruptable programs. When writing your own programs, if they are to be used while printing with the PRINT command (files in the print queue), they should be written to be interruptable as well. At no time should the IRQ or SWI3 vectors be changed in a utility which is to be run while printing. In general, good programming practice will yield interruptable programs.

SYSTEM MEMORY MAP

The following memory map shows the location of user RAM and several major sections of the FLEX operating system. All addresses are in hexadecimal.

ADDRESS	DESCRIPTION
0000 - BFFF	User RAM (Some of the lower end of this area is used by certain utilities such as NEWDISK.)
C000 - C07F	Stack Area (SP is initialized to C07F)
C080 - C0FF	Input Buffer
C100 - C6FF	Utility Command Area
C700 - C83F	Scheduler & Printer Spooler
C840 - C97F	System FCB
C980 - CBFF	System Files Area
CC00 - D3FF	DOS
D400 - DDFF	FMS
DE00 - DFFF	Disk Drivers

